



PROGRESS REPORT

Africa: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-05 · 152 systems and instruments tracked

Compiled 2026-09-05 by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository. Sections run from the region's institutions outwards to what funds them. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · INSTITUTIONS AND MANDATES · INSTRUMENTS AND HARMONISATION ·
SHARED SYSTEMS AND INFRASTRUCTURE · COORDINATION AND COLLABORATION · CAPACITY AND INCLUSION · FINANCE
· WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Of 152 bodies, instruments and systems on this place's ledger, 86 changed position between 2025-09-01 and 2026-09-05, 10 did not, 53 carry no stated baseline, and 3 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 756 sources for this place in the window — 115 in the earlier half (2025-09 to 2026-02), 641 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-09). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

The year's continental movement was institutional rather than operational. Bodies were constituted, positions adopted and memoranda signed across artificial intelligence, connectivity and payments, and very little of it yet carries a delivery figure. The Africa AI Council was established, an Algiers declaration on telecommunications sovereignty was adopted, a continental payments rail passed 190 institutions in 28 countries, and the digital trade protocol still has no ratification count. Where numbers exist they are mostly one side's own: an operator's ranking, a company's training pledge, a foundation's cohort call.

One fact runs underneath the rest. Official development assistance fell sharply in 2025 with a further fall expected, and the agency that said so told its board its model is shifting from delivering aid to mobilising investment — which bears on almost every programme here without naming one.

Institutions and mandates

Regional collaboration

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
AfCFTA Digital Trade Corridor	Did not exist	a joint venture agreement signed in Accra on 31 August 2026 between the AfCFTA Secretariat and a Ghanaian technology company to build a corridor facilitating, tracking and settling cross-border trade transactions in compliance with continental trade rules and reducing reliance on routing payments through third countries	ADVANCED
AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade	State parties committed to expedite ratification and domestication under eight calls to action; no ratification count is published with them; the calls carry no enforcement mechanism, no ratification deadline and no named financing	Eight annexes to the protocol were approved in February 2025 and the intellectual-property annexes adopted in February 2026, and all of them still await national ratification and incorporation; the July 2026 calls to action to expedite ratification carry no enforcement mechanism, no deadline and no named financing, and no ratification count is published	ADVANCED, UNRATIFIED
AfCFTA Secretariat	Council bureau chaired by Egypt; the digital trade protocol adopted but no forum convened on it	Nigeria in the chair with digital trade among four stated priorities, a second digital trade forum held and a data-exchange system of the Secretariat's own launched	ADVANCED
Africa Internet Governance Forum	Baseline not held	The fifteenth annual forum is scheduled for the Labadi Beach Hotel, Accra, from 2 to 5 November 2026, running a main forum alongside youth, parliamentarian and Day Zero tracks and the African School on Internet Governance; session times, venues and speakers were not published when the schedule was read	ADVANCED
African Telecommunications Union (ATU)	Under the mandate set at the sixth session in Algiers in 2022, chaired by Algeria	A secretary general elected for the next four-year term, a 25-state administrative council seated, the chairmanship passed to Nigeria and a ministerial declaration adopted; the union's plenipotentiary conference ratified the return of its headquarters to Kinshasa on 23 July 2026, after the host state paid more than US\$1.4m in arrears, with no date stated for the move	ADVANCED
African Union Commission	Author of the Continental AI Strategy and the Digital Transformation Strategy, with no continental digital partnership agreement on record in the year before	Two cooperation instruments signed inside six months, with a US technology company and with the ITU, and a coordinated African position taken to the first global AI-governance dialogue	ADVANCED
AFRIC governance and receivership	Under an appeal-court order of 15 October 2024 directing the Official Receiver to complete the board election within two months, in substitution for the six months ordered in September 2023; no reconstituted board at the window's start, six months past that deadline	the board having constituted an Appeal Committee, appointments effective immediately for a term to 31 December 2026, and a public policy meeting called for Cape Town on 18 November 2026	ADVANCED
Algiers Declaration on African Telecommunications Sovereignty and Integrated Connectivity 2026-2030	Did not exist	Adopted as a continental position on integrated terrestrial, submarine and satellite infrastructure, local data centres, exchange points and cybersecurity; no work programme or text held	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Cairo Declaration on child rights and design accountability	Did not exist	At drafting stage, its six pillars covering safety-by-design requirements, restrictions on exploitative targeting and manipulative practices, age-appropriate design standards and related obligations on companies	ADVANCED
Digital Parliaments Project Africa	Did not exist	Launch cohort of the parliaments of Ghana, Botswana and South Africa, the National Assemblies of the Gambia and Senegal, and the Pan-African Parliament, led by the POPVOX-DPP Foundation with the House Democracy Partnership; no amount, duration, funder or work programme stated	ADVANCED
Smart Africa Alliance	37 member states, working to the previous strategy	42 member states and a three-year strategy whose flagships are a data exchange, an innovation platform and digital identity; the secretariat issued two calls for expressions of interest on 13 August, one for content-delivery providers across broadband, data governance and cybersecurity and green-digital domains, and one for a consultancy to draft a gender-inclusion strategy for women's participation in ICT policymaking and governance, both closing on 31 August	ADVANCED
State parties to the AfCFTA	Baseline not held	49 of 54 signatories had deposited instruments of ratification as at July 2026, and Somalia is to become the 50th state party on depositing its instrument in September 2026, having agreed with the Secretariat a sequence running from ratification through domesticating the electronic tariff book and configuring preferential tariffs in its customs administration to a first shipment (2026-08)	ADVANCED
Africa Prosperity Dialogues 2027	Did not exist	A fifth edition of a continental forum scheduled for 27 to 29 January 2027 in Accra, themed on free movement, seamless payment and increased trade, with registration opening 7 September 2026. At its launch a continental development agency's director of infrastructure, industrialisation, trade and regional integration said political declarations alone were no longer enough and that free movement, integrated infrastructure and a single market will fail without harmonised regulations, technical standards and legal systems	BASELINE NOT HELD
African Financial Stability Committee	BASELINE NOT HELD	Hosted by the Association of African Central Banks and running a Macroprudential Policy Development and Implementation Working Group and an African Financial Stability Report Working Group; the continental portal carrying its mandate, structure, member central banks, meeting calendar and working groups was built and launched by the Central Bank of Egypt rather than by the association's secretariat, executing a decision of the 47th Assembly of Governors of 2025-11-28	Baseline not held
African Financial Stability Report	BASELINE NOT HELD	Inaugural 2024-2025 edition endorsed for publication by the Association of African Central Banks' 47th Assembly of Governors at Yaounde on 2025-11-28 and released in July 2026, covering 46 countries on data as at December 2024 with analysis through 2025. Its payments chapter, built from 26 central banks' published data, records that about 67 per cent of the continent's payment infrastructures are national systems run by central banks and 56 per cent of established systems handle retail, and finds the landscape fragmented, interoperability still limited and the operationalisation of regional and pan-African systems facing continuing challenges	Baseline not held

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
ATU Strategic Plan 2027-2031	BASELINE NOT HELD	A draft Strategic Plan for 2027-2031 was circulated to member states for comment ahead of CPL-26; the draft is not published, and no adopted plan, budget or final acts of the conference are held	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Central African regional framework on cross-border data flows	Did not exist	Central African member states met in Douala from 31 August to 4 September 2026 to draft a regional framework governing cross-border data flows, assessing national readiness and consolidating country contributions into a consensus on the pillars of a future regional instrument. Technical and financial support came from the German development agency, a continental development agency, the Economic Commission for Africa and the African Union Commission, which frames the work against the continental digital transformation strategy for 2020 to 2030	BASELINE NOT HELD
Korea-Africa Economic Cooperation ministerial framework	Baseline not held	Eighth ministerial set for Seoul under the theme of artificial intelligence and digital infrastructure, convened by the continental development bank with new co-financing expected	BASELINE NOT HELD

The institutional layer moved most. A council of 42 heads of state was established for artificial intelligence, a secretary general was elected at the telecommunications union, a continental sovereignty declaration was adopted for 2026-2030, and a parliaments project opened with a six-legislature cohort. The continental free trade area now counts 49 of 54 signatories as having deposited instruments of ratification.

What has not moved is the digital trade protocol's own domestication: state parties committed to expedite it under eight calls to action and the base still holds no ratification count. The regional registry remains under an appeal-court order and a receivership, and closed the year naming a chief executive designate for January 2027 while Mauritius police confirmed [two alleged forgery cases](#) arising from the board election it annulled without ever stating why. A mandate is cheaper to adopt than to work, and the difference between the two is what this section cannot yet show.

Instruments and harmonisation

Strategies, plans and policies

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Anti-IFFs Policy Tracker	Piloted eighteen months in Cote d'Ivoire, Ghana, Liberia, Namibia, Uganda and Zambia, built by Tax Justice Network Africa with the AU Commission's ETTIM department and the African Tax Administration Forum	Endorsed for continental roll-out as a standing self-assessment instrument scoring anti-IFF policy, legal, institutional and data-sharing frameworks; no roll-out timetable, country list or governance body named	ADVANCED
AUDA-NEPAD island economies programme	Did not exist	A country-owned framework for seven island states built around industrialisation, digitalisation, corridors and AI, in partnership with the Republic of Korea; the ministerial communique adopting it is not published	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Africa Technology Policy Tracker	BASELINE NOT HELD	A continental register built by the Carnegie Endowment with the African Telecommunications Union, consolidating national digital-economy laws, policies and regulations across infrastructure, platforms, skills and innovation; it indexes adopted documents only, weights nothing and assesses neither implementation nor rights compatibility. The counts reported on 2026-07-30 are 60 documents for Nigeria, 59 for Rwanda and 19 for Zambia	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Data protection

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Signatures and ratifications of the Malabo Convention	21 of 55 signed, 20 ratified or acceded and 20 deposited (2026-02-02, the depositary's register)	Equatorial Guinea, where the Convention was adopted and after whose then-capital it is named, signed on 2026-07-28 and has not deposited an instrument of ratification	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Malabo Convention	In force, and the continental benchmark against which national data-protection regimes are measured	Unchanged in text; a majority of the Union's 55 members remain outside it twelve years after adoption	NO CHANGE
African Union Data Policy Framework	Baseline not held	In force as the continental reference framework, with about a third of the 54 member states aligned to it on a 2026-08-11 analysis, and 25 national regulatory sandboxes recorded across 15 countries by late 2024; no compliance mechanism, reporting cycle or enforcement route is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD

Standards

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Africa PKI Forum harmonisation of digital-trust rules	Did not exist	Participants called for harmonised African rules so that digital credentials, electronic signatures and documents can be verified across borders; nothing is adopted and no instrument, timetable or signatory list is on file. The call was renewed at a Nigerian technology expo on 2 and 3 September 2026, where the Nigerian identity commission's director-general named public key infrastructure the irreplaceable foundation for cross-border authentication, electronic signatures and accountability and urged national and subnational bodies to align certificate policies, trust-service governance, data-privacy and legal frameworks, and the AfCFTA secretary-general warned that national systems unable to communicate with one another would replace physical fragmentation with digital fragmentation	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
African Common Proposals for WRC-27	Preliminary African Common Proposals for WRC-27 and RA-27 are to be consolidated from the recommendations of the African Telecommunications Union's WRC-27 working groups at the third African Preparatory Meeting, Tunis, 7-11 September 2026, co-organised with Tunisia's Agence Nationale des Frequences; no proposal text is published	The union's third radiocommunication working group met as an e-meeting convened from Nairobi from 18 to 21 August 2026, input contributions having closed on 11 August, to prepare its recommendations for the third African Preparatory Meeting; the meeting's own output is not published, and no proposal text is published	ADVANCED
AFRINIC Constitution (Bylaws)	Fifth version in force since December 2020, with no review under way	The Bylaws Review Committee ran a first consultation from 2026-04-20, extended on 2026-05-08 to close 2026-05-17, published a draft amended Constitution on 2026-08-04 for a second consultation that closed 2026-08-21, and opened a third round on 2026-08-25 closing 30 August while it reviews the second round's submissions. It has now obtained an independent external legal opinion on a dispute resolution clause and on the legality of the board's discretionary power to terminate resource membership, and states that it does not at this stage intend to recommend a dispute resolution clause and is considering options to strengthen the safeguards on the termination power; the opinion itself is withheld as privileged. The draft's Article 24, governing law and dispute resolution, was still blank in the 53-page draft members were asked to review provision by provision, carrying only a bracketed note that advice had been sought. A new Article 3 would write into the constitution that AFRINIC is the Regional Internet Registry for Africa and the Indian Ocean and that its governance will be periodically reviewed against internationally recognised governance standards; proposed article 9.8 would let a two-thirds board vote revoke the nomination committee and restart an election the board itself had judged to have failed; the current rule barring a conflicted director from voting would be dropped and recusal relocated into board policy, which matters because Mauritius company law lets an interested director vote after disclosure unless the constitution says otherwise; article 16 opens a wide advice channel with no register of advice given or received; and article 17.5 would create an acting chief executive office with no maximum term. The published-draft milestone slipped about six weeks against the Committee's own indicative timetable while the Special General Members Meeting stayed in September 2026, and no consolidation or analysis of any round's submissions is published	ADVANCED
AFRINIC IPv4 policy proposal AF PUB-2026-IPv4-001 (soft landing, recovered space and priority)	In Last Call, with the quarantine procedure it depends on posted on 30 July 2026	Ratified, on a cleanup procedure setting a quarantine period of a tentative twelve months that may run longer but never shorter (2026-08)	ADVANCED
AFRINIC IPv4 policy proposal AF PUB-2026-IPv4-002 (waiver of the 90% utilisation threshold)	Did not exist	an objection to the twelve-month quarantine floor in the published cleanup procedure carried past the Last Call boundary rather than resolved within it	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Good Financial Grant Practice Standard, revised	a continental standard for financial grant management	a revised edition of that standard launched by the continental standardisation body with a research foundation	ADVANCED
ISO-ARSO Kigali Agreement	Did not exist	A five-year technical-cooperation and standards-harmonisation framework between the international standards body and the African regional standards organisation, framed against the free-trade area's harmonisation push; no work programme, budget or standards list is published with it	ADVANCED
Continental ICT standardisation alignment	BASELINE NOT HELD	Talks opened on a coordinated continental approach across the standards lifecycle, from development through harmonised adoption and implementation by countries, naming fragmentation and the failure to translate continental and international standards into national frameworks as the problem	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Development bank programme on statistical data and metadata standards	Did not exist	The continental development bank's work to strengthen adoption of data and metadata standards across African statistical infrastructure, set out in a contribution to a central-bank statistics seminar held in October 2025 and published by the Bank for International Settlements in August 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD

AI

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Africa AI Council	Did not exist	Established under a board of 42 heads of state with the AU Commissioner for Energy and Infrastructure and the ITU Secretary-General; no work programme or output held in the nine months since	ADVANCED
African Humanitarian AI Citation Index	Did not exist	an index measuring whose knowledge generative artificial-intelligence answers cite when explaining African humanitarian crises, published by its researcher	ADVANCED
Free student access to a commercial assistant	Did not exist	A technology company offered African students one year of its paid artificial-intelligence assistant tier at no charge, pitched at study materials, assignments and planning	ADVANCED
Fund departmental paper on artificial intelligence in the region	Did not exist	A departmental paper on the potential of artificial intelligence across sub-Saharan Africa, held in full as published	ADVANCED
Pan-African AI governance research and advocacy project	Did not exist	A four-year research and advocacy project on pan-African AI governance, funded at EUR 1,873,314 and running 2026 to 2030, implemented by a consortium of a German university media research centre and three civil-society organisations; the position it argues from is common principles through continental institutions rather than 54 national AI regimes, covering data governance, AI ethics, procurement standards, regulatory sandboxes, cross-border research and capacity-building	ADVANCED
Africa AI Fund	Announced in April 2025 at US\$60bn, alongside the Africa AI Declaration, with nothing capitalised	Still cited as one pillar of the continental AI architecture; no capitalisation, governance structure or disbursement held	NO CHANGE
AU Continental AI Strategy	Adopted 2024-07-19 as the continental reference for national AI policy, on an implementation timeframe running 2025 to 2030	Unchanged in text, and the reference the Commission carried into global forums; ministers meeting at the ECA called for its translation into national frameworks. The instrument's own timetable runs Phase I across 2025-2026, a midterm review in 2027 and Phase II from 2028	NO CHANGE

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Monitoring and evaluation of the AU Continental AI Strategy	Provided for in the Strategy through an African AI readiness index, a public monitoring dashboard and regional AI observatories, with nothing published	Still nothing published; the Peace and Security Council requested the Commission and its AI Advisory Group to submit periodic reports on 2026-04-16, and the Strategy's own midterm review falls in 2027	NO CHANGE
Common African Position on AI and its Impact on Peace, Security, Democracy and Development	BASELINE NOT HELD	The Council requested the Commission to expedite the comprehensive study and the Common African Position and submit them for its consideration; a Policy Brief on AI for Peace, Security and Governance in Africa is reported in progress and no text is published	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Google Africa Applied AI Lab	Did not exist	A co-development programme based at the Accra AI Community Centre and run with the sponsor's AI futures fund, giving selected African startups from pre-seed to Series C+ pre-release access to its Gemini, Gemma and Veo models plus research mentorship and go-to-market support, with no equity taken and no cash award guaranteed; it closes with a demo day in Accra	BASELINE NOT HELD
Public capital committed to the AU Continental AI Strategy	Baseline not held	About US\$150m of public capital committed by African governments against an implementation cost the Strategy itself prices at between US\$250bn and US\$500bn - a fraction of one per cent - and an ambition to add US\$1.5 trillion to Africa's GDP by 2030; independent research over the Strategy's first eighteen months found the funding heavily concentrated in Kenya, Nigeria, South Africa and Egypt, with little reaching the remaining member states	BASELINE NOT HELD

Harmonisation advanced on paper and stalled in law. The continental data policy framework is in force as the reference, with about a third of member states aligned to it; the cyber and data convention is unchanged in text and had 21 of 55 signatures and 20 ratifications at the depositary's February 2026 register.

On standards the work is opening rather than closing: common proposals for the 2027 radio conference are to be consolidated from regional recommendations, and talks opened on a coordinated approach across the standards lifecycle. The registry's bylaws review ran three consultation rounds without publishing an analysis of any of them, and concluded on a privileged legal opinion that it will not recommend the dispute resolution clause its drafts left blank. Its address-policy docket shows the same shape: a proposal to waive the utilisation threshold reached Last Call with an evidence rule that the justification be [sufficiently documented](#) and no list of what would document it. None has produced an adopted instrument inside the window.

Shared systems and infrastructure

Connectivity

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
2026 Abuja Declaration on Meaningful Connectivity for Africa	Did not exist	Adopted, committing member states to technology-neutral regulation, continental harmonisation, fair access to spectrum and fibre, shared infrastructure and data governance; the text itself is not published	ADVANCED
Data customers and usage on the continent's largest operator	Average monthly data use of 10.8GB a customer	More than 307 million voice, 172 million data and 70 million mobile-money customers across sixteen markets at the end of 2025, with average monthly data use up to 12.5GB a customer from 10.8GB, on R38bn of capital spending on capacity, coverage and quality	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Harmonised national broadband mapping project	Did not exist	A 2025-2028 project to establish or strengthen harmonised national broadband mapping systems in eleven sub-Saharan regulators - Benin, Botswana, Burundi, Ethiopia, Ivory Coast, Kenya, Malawi, Nigeria, Uganda, Zambia and Zimbabwe - with a five-day intermediate GIS and data-management training opened at Lilongwe for practitioners from Malawi, Zimbabwe, Botswana and Zambia, hosted by the Malawian regulator and supported by the European Union	ADVANCED
Africa Digital Connectivity Infrastructure Report	BASELINE NOT HELD	Phase 1, Country Pilots, put out as an open consultancy tender at a stated budget of US\$165,000, funded jointly by the African Development Bank, the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank and the Multilateral Cooperation Center for Development Finance; the pilot countries and the terms of reference are not established	Baseline not held
Commercial 5G deployment and adoption across the continent	Baseline not held	61 operators across 37 African markets had launched commercial 5G services by the end of May 2026, 40 of them also running 5G fixed wireless access, after first launches in Algeria, Comoros, Egypt, Libya, Mauritania, Morocco and Tunisia over the preceding twelve months; 5G connections in Africa are put at just under 100 million by the end of 2026, 6.2% of total mobile connections, against a projected 3.4 billion and 37% worldwide, and among sixteen focus countries only Mauritius and South Africa had 5G population coverage above 50% as of May 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD
Mobile internet users and their measured economic value	Baseline not held	416 million Africans used mobile internet in 2025, generating a measured US\$240bn of economic value, put at 7.8% of continental GDP	BASELINE NOT HELD

Data Storage

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Sovereign AI cloud on edge data centres	Did not exist	The operator's AI factory is ranked 36th on the global list of the most powerful supercomputers, presented as evidence that African organisations can train and deploy models on infrastructure sited on the continent rather than abroad; the underlying offer remains AI processing units hosted inside an African edge data-centre network and sold as locally-hosted enterprise AI	ADVANCED
Continental dependence on foreign public cloud	Not held	African artificial-intelligence startups are exposed to hidden financial and operational risk where a large share of workloads sits with a single provider, against which a new generation of African-founded sovereign and low-latency cloud providers is emerging	BASELINE NOT HELD
Data centres the AfCFTA Secretariat states digital trade requires	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 700, against about 220 on the continent, on the Secretary General's statement at Marrakech	Baseline not held
Time for a data centre to reach 85% occupancy	BASELINE NOT HELD	Six to eight years in African markets against two to three in Europe, on the Africa Data Centres Association's 2026 Economic Report, which also puts 80-90% of the continent's data as still processed and stored abroad and projects the market at US\$9.2bn by 2029	Baseline not held

Energy

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Digitisation priorities in the national energy compacts	Did not exist	The smart-metering and grid-optimisation priorities set out in the national energy compacts are argued to be constrained across Africa by a fragmented low-power internet-of-things layer: narrowband deployment reaches only markets such as South Africa, Kenya and Nigeria, while the 2G and 3G networks early smart meters rely on are expected to be retired well inside a meter's ten to fifteen year life; the analysis calls for integrated energy and telecom planning, targeted incentives for low-power wide-area network rollout, and energy-telecom co-investment	ADVANCED

Cybersecurity

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Privileged access management for the African Union Commission's own networks	Did not exist	A request for bids for the supply and installation of a privileged access management solution for the Commission's own networks (Ref. ET-AUC-560865-GO-RFB), amended on 21 August 2026 to push the bid deadline from 27 August to 10 September 2026 and to restate the licence requirement as 8 administrator, 40 enterprise privileged-user, 25 business-user and 5 external-vendor subscriptions on three-year terms, with training raised from six staff to eight	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Reported cybercrime losses across the continent	About US\$192m reported (2024)	About US\$484m reported, more than double the 2024 figure, drawn from 36 member countries, with artificial intelligence involved in 55% of surveyed 2025 cybercrime cases and deepfake incidents up sevenfold between the second and fourth quarters of 2024; against that, only 8% of intelligence analysts are recorded as having advanced artificial-intelligence expertise and 94% of agencies as lacking digital forensics tools, and a single Ugandan deepfake investment scam is put at over US\$2m of losses	REGRESSED
Vendor-measured attack volume across the continent	None published	African organisations averaged 3,237 attacks a week in July 2026 against a global average of 2,336, behind Latin America at 3,561 and Asia-Pacific at 3,316; Angola was highest of the African markets broken out at 5,714, then Nigeria at 4,975, Kenya at 2,915 and South Africa at 2,195. Ransomware victims were up 87% year on year and the continent posted the world's highest phishing rate at 1 in 106 emails	ADVANCED
Standing in the global cybersecurity index	BASELINE NOT HELD	Mauritius, Rwanda, Kenya, Tanzania and Ghana in the top tier; Benin, Togo, Zambia and South Africa in the second; the majority of the continent below, scored across legal, technical and organisational measures, capacity building and international cooperation	Baseline not held

Data Exchange

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
ADAPT (Africa Digital Access and Public Infrastructure for Trade)	Did not exist	In pilot in Nigeria, Kenya and Morocco on the Secretary-General's statement to the second Digital Trade Forum; no live exchange, governing instrument or assessment held	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
AU Digital Agriculture Strategy implementation	Adopted for 2024-2030 with an average agricultural growth target of 6 per cent and an estimated US\$165 million continental implementation cost, prioritising national e-agriculture strategies over a uniform regional approach after a 2021 situation analysis covering all 55 member states	A continental workshop convened regional economic communities, union organs and participating countries to harmonise implementation, seeking interoperable agricultural data platforms, common data governance and alignment of national and regional systems with the continental digital transformation strategy and agriculture reporting	ADVANCED
IGAD SDMX regional statistical-systems capacity-building programme	Did not exist	Outcome stated as harmonised SDMX Data Structure Definitions and a long-term roadmap institutionalising SDMX across IGAD and its member states under Open Data Portal 2.0; no budget, adoption date or roadmap milestone published	ADVANCED
Petroleum producers' local content platform	Did not exist	a shared database mapping skills, industrial capacities and local suppliers across member countries, opened in Brazzaville and described by its owner as the first pan-African platform dedicated to local content	ADVANCED
SADX (Smart Africa Data Exchange)	Did not exist	Unveiled at Conakry on 2025-11-12 and taken into a technical mission with Rwanda, Benin and Ghana on trust chains, interface contracts and incident response; no live exchange held; the alliance and a German development agency say a digital identity issued in one of Rwanda, Ghana or Benin is now recognised in the other two, with eighteen further countries said to be joining, presented as the first step to a single African digital market by 2030	ADVANCED
AU Data Policy Framework	In force since February 2022 as the continental reference for data governance, with none of its operative texts drafted	Unchanged in text; the three operative frameworks it provides for went to validation in December 2025 and none is adopted or published	NO CHANGE
AU Guidelines for Integrating Data Provisions in Protocols on Digital Trade	Issued September 2023 as a reference guide for negotiators integrating data provisions into the AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade	Unchanged; no record is held of its provisions being carried into the Protocol or its annexes	NO CHANGE
Smart Africa cross-border data exchange guidelines	Drafted by eleven member states under the Council of African IT Agencies	No adopted text, signatory list or implementation record held in the year since the drafting session	NO CHANGE
AfCFTA Customs Modernisation Project	BASELINE NOT HELD	A public-private partnership under which Bergmans Security Consultants and Supplies Limited mobilises the financing for customs digital solutions, secure electronic exchange of customs information, coordinated border management, One Stop Border Posts, transit systems, electronic cargo tracking, non-intrusive inspection technology, integrated data centres, multilingual customs portals, risk management and data analytics across participating State Parties; the agreement builds on a memorandum of understanding concluded in July 2026 and nothing is recorded as deployed; a US\$3.1bn contract was signed with a Nigerian security consultancy to digitise customs across the 50 member states, aiming at real-time cargo tracking and reduced revenue leakage	<i>Baseline not held</i>

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Continental data governance frameworks	BASELINE NOT HELD	Three drafts - data categorisation and data sharing, cross-border data flows, and a continental open data strategy - validated with member states and regional economic communities; none submitted to AU policy organs and none published	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital Identity and CRVS

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
ADLI cohort on the AfCFTA Digital Identity Annex	Did not exist	Six countries across three trade corridors working on compliance with the annex, on a test-and-learn basis; no assessment or mutual-recognition decision held	ADVANCED
Adults holding official identification in Sub-Saharan Africa	None published on this basis	81% of adults, 82% of men against 79% of women, a 3.56-point gender gap (2025)	BASELINE NOT HELD
APAI-CRVS (Africa Programme on Accelerated Improvement of Civil Registration and Vital Statistics)	BASELINE NOT HELD	The 2017-2026 decade is closing and a 2027-2036 phase is opening; the African eCRVS Shared Asset (ACSA) is named as the shared continental standard intended to cut fragmented digital procurement across country systems, and Equatorial Guinea's Justice Ministry timed a free registration campaign for children aged 0-5 (10-14 August 2026) to the decade's close. No AU statement of the new phase's content, financing or targets is held	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Continental ID and data-protection law analyser	Baseline not held	An open-source tool launched by a university research network comparing identity and data-protection laws across more than 50 African countries, built as a retrieval-augmented chatbot and stated as intended to help states harmonise their frameworks; no usage figure, governance arrangement or maintenance commitment is published	BASELINE NOT HELD
Smart Africa digital identity blueprint	BASELINE NOT HELD	The alliance secretariat's first-edition blueprint for mutually recognised digital identity across member states, setting out the trust alliance, levels of assurance and the case for interoperable identity, drawn up after a member-state workshop	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital Payments and Fintech

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
African take-up of China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System	Baseline not held	a cross-border payments startup launching direct yuan payouts into Chinese bank accounts from dollar, euro, sterling and stablecoin balances, alongside continental take-up of China's own cross-border interbank system	ADVANCED
Association of African Central Banks (AACB)	No decision of the Assembly on continental payment harmonisation held	A list of 54 decisions, of which decision 21 rules that the Payment Systems Directive for Africa is not to be led by an entity external to central banks and directs its own task force to lead the work	ADVANCED
Banks and countries connected to PAPSS	28 banks within nine months of launch, against an ambition of all 500 to 600 African banks (2022)	28 countries and over 190 banks and financial-technology firms connected, with the Central African central bank acceding in July 2026 and the West African central bank's pilot pending; connecting the EAC, West, Central and Southern African regional systems is put at reaching more than 60% of African countries, and no continent-wide transaction value is published (2026-08)	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
CARICOM Payment and Settlement System (CAPSS)	Did not exist; modelled on PAPSS since CARICOM governors' unanimous October 2023 selection	Proof of concept complete in two countries; the ECCB Governor says at least two more central banks are needed for the initial pilot; not commercially operational, with settlement, FX, liquidity, AML and interoperability arrangements unresolved	ADVANCED
COMESA digital retail payments platform	Not held	The regional clearing house published the scheme rulebook setting operational and governance rules for instant low-cost cross-border retail payments, and a gender audit and strategy to 2030 drawn from research along the Malawi-Zambia corridor; it advertised three platform posts on 24 August 2026 - head of technology, platform and infrastructure engineer and security engineer - whose duties establish that the platform is built on Mojaloop, runs an AWS production environment against an on-premises staging footprint and Kubernetes clusters, and that the engineering, infrastructure and information-security functions are being recruited rather than staffed	ADVANCED
Fintech volume carried by the continent's largest operator	23 billion transactions carrying more than US\$500bn across the whole of 2025, up 15% in volume	13.0 billion transactions carrying US\$330.5bn in the half, up 17.2% in volume and 33.8% in value in constant currency, on 70.8 million monthly active mobile-money users	ADVANCED
Pan-African Payment and Settlement System (PAPSS)	Operating from January 2022 across West and East African cores, with no Central African central bank participating	Extended into Central Africa by the BEAC's accession, wired into a national switch in Kenya for the first time, and carrying a wallet-based Nigeria-to-Ghana rail settled in naira	ADVANCED
PAPSSCARD	Did not exist	A continental card scheme launched to route African card payments inside the continent rather than through global networks; no issuance, volume or country coverage held	ADVANCED
Regulatory obstacles to instant payment interoperability	Did not exist	instant payment systems across the continent described as meeting a regulatory wall, with divergent national rules limiting interoperability	REGRESSED
Stablecoin settlement rails serving African cross-border payments	Not held	Described by a pan-African payments operator's product chief as moving from speculative use into the plumbing of remittances and business settlement, on the evidence of Mastercard's agreement to acquire BVNK at up to US\$1.8bn and Visa's stablecoin-card expansion through Stripe's Bridge into more than 100 countries, African markets among them; a first named African deployment is Flutterwave's tie-up with Caliza offering USD accounts with USDC and USDT conversion. At a UN Economic Commission for Africa webinar on 18 August 2026, market supervisors from Uganda's Capital Markets Authority, the Bank of Ghana and the Financial Services Commission of Mauritius set out three national approaches to virtual assets and stablecoins and agreed on consumer protection, financial stability, regulatory clarity and monetary sovereignty as shared objectives, arguing that compatible outcomes and supervisory cooperation matter more than identical legislation; the Commission put continental digital-asset users above 54 million, Nigeria alone at about 25.9 million, against a global tokenised money market that passed US\$300bn in 2025	ADVANCED
UnionPay online acceptance through Standard Bank	A collaboration between the two parties dating from 2024, with no merchant count published	Online-payment acceptance for nearly 900 merchants across Botswana, Ghana, Kenya, Malawi, Namibia, Tanzania, Uganda, Zambia and Zimbabwe, settling in local currency, US dollars or both, against a stated African footprint of about 7 million UnionPay cards issued	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Cost of sending money within Africa	Baseline not held	Put at 8.78% of the amount sent against the SDG target of 3% (2026-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD
Payment Systems Directive for Africa (PSDA)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Directed to be led by central banks rather than an external entity, with the Assembly's own task force on payment system integration to lead harmonisation; no draft directive held	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Unmet trade finance demand	BASELINE NOT HELD	US\$74bn to US\$100bn of unmet trade finance demand, with commercial banks intermediating about 23% of the continent's trade against 40% over 2011 to 2019, and intra-African trade at US\$213.8bn in 2025 (2026-08)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Registries

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
OHADA Uniform Act on General Commercial Law (AUDCG) and the RCCM business register	Not held	The founding instrument for the business register across OHADA's seventeen member states: it creates and governs the Registre du Commerce et du Credit Mobilier, defines the merchant and entreprenant statuses, sets the register's organisation and registration rules and the national and regional company-record files, and provides for their computerisation	BASELINE NOT HELD

Sectoral management information systems

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Africa CDC Central Data Repository	Did not exist	A federated repository integrating national surveillance, laboratory and programme data in which member states retain ownership of their data	ADVANCED
Regional Health Data Hub	Did not exist	a shared digital platform launched from Addis Ababa integrating fragmented health data across all 47 member states of the region, bringing maternal, newborn, child and adolescent health and noncommunicable disease data together	ADVANCED
African Initiative on Transforming Health Financing (ECA)	Did not exist	A five-year Economic Commission for Africa initiative running 2026 to 2030, launched in Tangier in April 2026, built on seven interlinked outcomes of which digital governance is one, alongside fiscal embedding, innovative financing instruments, primary health care modernisation, regional public goods, institutional capacity and narrative transformation. Its digital component is a shared data and intelligence platform for quantifying national financing gaps, real-time interoperable health and budget data, and what the Commission's chief of staff called a digital twin of the health budget underwriting multi-year compacts between finance and health ministries; the Commission puts fewer than a third of health systems in low-income settings as able to track spending digitally in real time, governments as financing under 41% of total health expenditure on average, and 30 to 40% of health spending as lost to inefficiency	BASELINE NOT HELD

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
African Regional Integration Synthesized Index (ASRII) platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	The African Union Commission's platform for submission, validation, automated computation and dissemination of regional integration scores across political, economic, infrastructure, and human and social pillars, developed with the regional economic communities, the Economic Commission for Africa and the African Development Bank to replace manual data collection. Deployment to the regional economic communities began with a four-day training of 20 core participants at the ECOWAS Commission in Abuja on 4-7 August 2026, at which its Secretary General said the Commission holds no centralised database of the status, amendments and implications of regional legal protocols	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Continental behavioural intelligence and infodemic management framework	Did not exist	The continental disease control body and member states validated components of a behavioural intelligence and infodemic management framework at a five-day meeting in Mombasa ending 3 September 2026, with technical experts and public health leaders from Burundi, Ghana, Kenya, Mauritania, Sierra Leone and Zimbabwe alongside a West African regional surveillance centre and a WHO infodemic response alliance. The framework is to connect community feedback, social listening, behavioural and social data, service-delivery and programme data and rapid research into decision-ready intelligence; the continental body states explicitly that it is not another database or reporting platform, and provides stewardship through common standards, technical guidance, coordination and quality assurance while member states retain control of national systems	BASELINE NOT HELD

Use of satellite data

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
African Meteorological Satellite Application Facility (AMSAF)	Did not exist	A continental facility inaugurated under the European Union-funded Strengthening Early Warning in Africa project, developing coordinated satellite-derived nowcasting and impact-based forecasting products for African meteorological services on Meteosat Third Generation data; no participating-service count, budget or product schedule is published	ADVANCED
West and Central Africa biomass productivity monitoring	Did not exist	A humanitarian agency's regional biomass yearly production and anomaly tables, computed from Copernicus dry-matter productivity using Sentinel-3 OLCI, PROBA-V and SPOT-VEGETATION data and published to administrative level 3 across West and Central Africa; the held capture is the dataset listing rather than the data	ADVANCED

The shared-infrastructure record is the one place where continental numbers exist, and they are uncomfortable. The trade secretariat's own estimate is that digital trade requires several times the number of data centres the continent has, and a facility here takes two to three times as long to reach the occupancy that finances it as one in Europe — the gap is the demand curve as much as the capacity.

Against that, an African operator's AI factory took a place in the top fifty of the global supercomputer list, which is a capability statement rather than a utilisation one. A connectivity declaration was adopted at Abuja, a harmonised broadband mapping project runs to 2028, and a continental infrastructure report reached its first country pilots as an open tender. Commercial 5G now runs from 61 operators in 37 markets, but of the sixteen countries the

industry's own study examines only Mauritius and South Africa cover more than half their population, so the technology's footprint is a market count rather than a reach. The union commission meanwhile put its own privileged-access management out to bid, which is the smallest and most concrete item in the section.

Coordination and collaboration

ICT Industry

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Charging for business messages on a dominant messenger	Service messages on the business platform free of charge	Free service messages to end from 1 October 2026, with businesses charged for every delivered message at rates varying by country and by message type, a cost increase for African companies that rely heavily on the messenger for customer service	REGRESSED

Innovation ecosystem

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Foundation startup incubation cohort	Did not exist	A foundation-funded incubation programme opened applications for a second continental cohort of technology startups	ADVANCED
Multi-country mapping of innovation-support organisations	BASELINE NOT HELD	A EUR120,000 procurement opened by a European development agency for a multi-country mapping of African entrepreneurship- and innovation-support organisations under a Europe-Africa digital innovation programme	Baseline not held

US / hyperscaler activities

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
America First Global Health Strategy data-sharing agreements	Did not exist; no bilateral United States health agreement of this kind on record before December 2025	Memorandums worth US\$20bn signed with more than 30 countries since December 2025, on a model Data Sharing Agreement giving the United States at-will access to seven classes of national health system for 25 years with a 10-year post-termination tail; Ghana refused in April 2026, Zimbabwe withdrew in February 2026 and Zambia shelved in May 2026, and Kenya's framework is before the Court of Appeal with a final ruling due at the end of October 2026; the State Department's standard-form memorandum, held as a blank template dated 2026-03-11, commits a partner government to name and run its electronic medical record, laboratory, pharmacy, surveillance, commodity-inventory and national data warehouse systems, to load 90 per cent of clinical encounters into the electronic medical record within two years of rollout in a facility, to enter a data sharing agreement expected to run twenty-five years, and to provide specimens and genetic sequence data of pathogens with epidemic potential within five days of detection, with section 4.7 making failure on those commitments grounds for changing or discontinuing the assistance; the signed texts are withheld, the department having published a subset of the memorandums in March 2026 and then removed public access, and a freedom-of-information suit covering sixteen African countries (Public Citizen v. Department of State, No. 1:26-cv-01137, D.D.C.) was unresolved when filed on 2026-04-02; a rights organisation's clause-by-clause assessment of the seven signed memorandums it holds - Ethiopia, Kenya, Mozambique, Nigeria, Rwanda, Liberia and Uganda - reports that the model's terms were not applied uniformly: all seven require broad audit access, three (Liberia, Mozambique and Rwanda) commit to supplying any data requested for that audit with no privacy safeguard stated, two (Liberia and Nigeria) defer the data-sharing arrangement to an unpublished appendix, and the specimen and pathogen-sequencing clause appears in five of the seven, with Liberia and Kenya outside it Eight United States senators wrote to the Secretary of State in the week to 2026-08-19 challenging the demands for direct access to partner governments' own health-data systems as a condition of lifesaving aid, calling them unprecedented and at odds with United States policy on the data of American citizens, and requesting a briefing on the agreements' data requirements and a written answer by the end of August 2026.	ADVANCED, REFUSED BY THREE STATES AND CHALLENGED IN THE UNITED STATES SENATE
US-AUC Strategic Investment Working Group	Did not exist	Agreed to channel US private investment into AU-backed infrastructure including digital transformation, on an investment-in-place-of-aid posture; no membership, meeting or work programme held	ADVANCED

China activities

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Chinese artificial-intelligence cooperation centres with the African Union	<i>Baseline not held</i>	The China-Africa Digital Technology Cooperation Center was formally inaugurated at Hangzhou on 28 August 2026 as a standing operational platform for results display, market-entry services, industry matchmaking, training and development research, four days after running its first high-level training programme; the opening drew officials, think tanks and executives from 18 African countries and the African Telecommunications Union, UNDP, UNICEF and the Smart Africa Alliance, and a same-day matchmaking session produced cooperation intentions in digital infrastructure, AI applications, cybersecurity and digital-skills training	ADVANCED
China-Africa Digital Cooperation Development Action Plan	Issued 2024-07-29 by China and 26 African states across six cooperation actions, with a three-year target of ten joint digital transformation demonstration projects and 1,000 personnel trained	Unchanged; no progress report, no accession beyond the original 26 states and no delivery against the three-year targets is held	NO CHANGE
African membership of the World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organisation	Did not exist	Ten African states joined the twenty-nine founding members of a new World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organisation agreed at the 2026 World AI Conference in Shanghai, where the body is to be headquartered; Algeria, Cameroon, Ethiopia, Kenya and South Africa are among the African founders. The same announcement carried 5,000 artificial-intelligence training places for developing countries over five years and international application cooperation centres with partners including the African Union	BASELINE NOT HELD
ATU memorandum with the China Academy of Information and Communications Technology	Not held	A memorandum signed in 2025 between the African Telecommunications Union and the China Academy of Information and Communications Technology on joint research, capacity development, technology transfer and next-generation networks, which the Union names as the foundation for its Secretary-General's participation in an Advanced Seminar on African Digital Development and Transformation that opened in Hangzhou on 24 August 2026, where he carried the priorities of its 52 member states	BASELINE NOT HELD
Chinese intelligent weather-warning system in Africa	Did not exist	China signed agreements with Cote d'Ivoire, Guinea and Cameroon to extend an intelligent weather-warning system across Africa, and plans deployment in 30 countries; a second-generation Djibouti installation raises forecast resolution from 9km to 3km	BASELINE NOT HELD

EU activities

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
AU-Germany strategic dialogue	No dated session held in the base	Reviewed the partnership and named AI governance and cybersecurity among the areas for cooperation, within a dialogue that is principally about peace and security	ADVANCED, MARGINAL

India activities

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
India-Africa digital public infrastructure cooperation	Did not exist	India's external affairs ministry received an official delegation from Ethiopia, Sierra Leone, Malawi, Zambia, Rwanda and the African Union Commission on using digital public infrastructure to promote development, improve governance, widen inclusion and strengthen the delivery of citizen services. The visit was coordinated by the United Nations Development Programme's India office	BASELINE NOT HELD

External engagement arrived faster than the continent's own coordination. The United States agreed a working group to channel private investment into union-backed infrastructure and signed bilateral health data-sharing agreements with seven states; China opened the first training programme under an announced artificial-intelligence cooperation and continues a 2024 action plan with 26 African states; Germany reviewed its strategic dialogue.

None of the three carries a disbursement, a site or a delivery date in the base. What the section can show is the shape of the approach rather than its effect, and a commercial decision — a dominant messenger ending free service messages on its business platform — is the item most likely to have reached an African user this year.

Capacity and inclusion

Training and skills

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
AYCE Digital (Advancing Youth Careers and Employment)	Did not exist	Launched as a five-year foundation-funded digital-skills and employment initiative run by a United States university, targeting foundational digital literacy for more than 50,000 learners, intermediate workforce credentials for 10,000 and advanced technical certifications for 2,500 in fields including artificial intelligence, cloud computing and project management, delivered through universities, refugee-serving organisations and more than 100 local facilitators	ADVANCED
iPRIS regulatory capacity programme	Did not exist	A EUR 9.5m European Union programme running 2023 to 2028 to build regulatory capacity for inclusive, secure and competitive digital markets, operationalised at a regional conference on electronic-communications and postal regulation hosted by a national regulator; no participating-regulator count or output is published	ADVANCED
Pan-African media innovation programme	Did not exist	A six-week certified course for 42 journalists, editors and practitioners from ten countries, covering media innovation and entrepreneurship, digital transformation and platform economies, digital journalism and analytics, and media ethics and governance	ADVANCED

Access to services

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Cotonou Declaration on digital transformation in West and Central Africa	Did not exist	Ministers committed to equipping persons with disabilities, alongside youth and women, with digital and entrepreneurial skills, and to creating two million digital-economy jobs benefiting those groups by 2028; the declaration sets out expected results, partnerships and financial commitments, governance and monitoring, and names no budget figure against the jobs target	ADVANCED

Digital divides

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Smartphone shipments and entry-level affordability	Three consecutive years of shipment growth to the second quarter of 2025, with aggressive price reductions in that quarter	Shipments fell 7% year on year in the second quarter of 2026, the first decline in three years, with the sub-\$100 segment down 34% - nearly three million units - and the average selling price up \$41 to \$202; the research house forecasts a 26% decline for 2026, memory now accounts for nearly 60% of the bill of materials for sub-\$400 devices and over 64% under \$99, and an entry-level handset can cost up to 73% of a low-income adult's monthly income in sub-Saharan Africa	REGRESSED
Women and girls digital-inclusion accelerator	BASELINE NOT HELD	An industry-body accelerator backed by two private foundations opened its next call for digital-inclusion solutions for women and girls across India and sub-Saharan Africa, with a grant amount listed at INR 42,000,000	<i>Baseline not held</i>

The base holds almost nothing continental on capacity, and the one item it does hold is an industry body's. A women and girls digital-inclusion accelerator opened, backed by two private foundations, with no baseline behind it and no cohort figure yet published.

That is the finding rather than an omission: skills and inclusion programmes are run nationally and appear on the country ledgers, so this section stays thin until a continental instrument exists to fill it. The pledges that do appear are made at continental level and delivered, if at all, somewhere else.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Share of the African Union's budget financed by its own members	About 22 to 25 per cent, a decade after the 2016 Kigali Decision	Unchanged on the newest figure held; the Union's 2025 programme budget was 77.5 per cent externally funded	NO CHANGE

MoUs and other agreements

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
AUC-Google memorandum on AI	Did not exist	Signed on AI and cloud infrastructure, skills, research and AI policy, with a pledge to train three million students and teachers by 2030	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
AUC-ITU cooperation memorandum	Did not exist	Signed across AI, digital public infrastructure, skills, connectivity, cybersecurity, space technology and standards, naming the Commission the continental coordinating partner for the 55 member states	ADVANCED
Afreximbank Academy and CreditRegistry financial-literacy memorandum	Did not exist	A three-year memorandum announced from Cairo on 25 August 2026 between the African Export-Import Bank's corporate academy and a credit-information company, integrating the latter's Africa Consumer Credit Academy curriculum into the academy's learning platform and covering digital financial literacy, credit education and trade capacity-building; it also undertakes to drive awareness and take-up of the bank's MANSA due-diligence repository and of PAPSS. A first initiative targets 20,000 to 30,000 learners, against a stated ambition of reaching about three million families and businesses	BASELINE NOT HELD
Five-year telecommunications and digital-infrastructure memorandum with an Indian technology company	Did not exist	A five-year memorandum of agreement between an Indian technology company, a continental investment council and an Ivorian mobile operator to develop telecommunications and digital public infrastructure across the continent, dated 2026-08-07 and fully executed on 2026-08-19 per a regulatory filing. It covers national fibre backbones, 4G and 5G, submarine cable landing stations, internet exchange points, telecom towers, and digital identity, national interoperability, e-government and digital payment platforms. No financial commitment is disclosed	BASELINE NOT HELD

New investments

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
African technology equity and debt funding	US\$3.25bn in total equity and debt funding across 534 deals in 2024	US\$4.1bn in 2025, up about 25% year on year and the strongest level since 2022, across 570 deals, up 7%; debt reached its highest volume ever at US\$1.6bn, up 63% on a 40% rise in the number of debt transactions and making up almost half of total capital raised, while equity funding grew 8% on a broadly stable deal count, so the growth came through larger ticket sizes rather than more transactions	ADVANCED
Development agency shift from aid delivery to investment mobilisation	Did not exist	A United Nations development agency told its executive board that its finance model is shifting from delivering aid to using scarce public resources to unlock investment at scale, citing official development assistance down 23.3% in 2025 with a further fall expected	ADVANCED
Digital Africa Seed Fund	Did not exist	A closed-end seed-stage fund with a ten-year horizon, sized at EUR 30m with a hard cap of EUR 50m, targeting 30 startups across 20 priority African countries at an average first ticket of EUR 300,000, and positioned as the seed step between the sponsor's pre-seed vehicle and institutional Series A investors	ADVANCED
Digitalisation of cooperative agricultural financial institutions	Did not exist	EUR 12,000,000 committed by a bilateral development ministry to digitalise cooperative agricultural financial institutions in West Africa	ADVANCED
Foundation call for AI in family planning	Did not exist	A private foundation opened a call for proposals using artificial intelligence to widen access to digital contraception information across sub-Saharan Africa, offering up to US\$500,000 a project, with applications closing on 25 August 2026	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Hewlett Foundation grant to BudgIT (general operating support)	Did not exist	US\$1,000,000 committed (US\$500,000 disbursed) as general operating support to BudgIT's budget-transparency and civic-tech work	ADVANCED
Hewlett Foundation grant to BudgIT (learning systems and communications)	Did not exist	US\$50,000 committed and fully disbursed to strengthen BudgIT's learning systems and strategic communications	ADVANCED
Hewlett Foundation grant to Cenfri (digital transformation programme)	Did not exist	US\$300,000 committed (US\$150,000 disbursed) to renew Cenfri's work on digital transformation and its link to evidence-informed policymaking across Africa	ADVANCED
Hewlett Foundation grant to Data4Change (Data Hub: Africa)	Did not exist	US\$400,000 committed (US\$200,000 disbursed) to Data4Change's Africa Hub, building community-generated evidence for policy and practice in East and West Africa	ADVANCED
Hewlett Foundation grant to ICED (AI-enabled evidence generation)	Did not exist	US\$100,000 committed and fully disbursed for the International Centre for Evaluation and Development to adopt AI-enabled evidence generation institution-wide	ADVANCED
IFC equity investment in Jumia	Did not exist	US\$25m of IFC equity inside a wider US\$50m raise	ADVANCED
Investment in a carrier-neutral digital infrastructure platform	Did not exist	a shareholder subscription agreement signed in Riyadh for a combined US\$300m investment from a continental infrastructure financier and a Saudi investment company, the largest capital raise in the platform's history	ADVANCED
Mergers and acquisitions in the digital economy	68 deals across the whole of 2025	84 deals worth an estimated US\$11.4bn in disclosed value between 1 January and 17 August 2026	ADVANCED
Saviu II venture capital fund	Did not exist	A continental development bank committed EUR 6.5m - EUR 4.5m as equity and a EUR 2m first-loss tranche on behalf of the European Commission under its Boost Africa programme - to a seed-stage technology fund that is to place at least 60% of commitments in Francophone West and Central Africa, investing EUR 500,000 to EUR 3m in about twenty start-ups	ADVANCED
Share of funded African tech startups led by a female chief executive	17 of 178 funded ventures, 9.6%, taking 7.9% of the capital (2025)	5 of 60, 8.3%, taking 2.8% of the capital (2026 to May)	REGRESSED
TaxDev III (IFS tax and social-protection policy data programme)	Did not exist	Institute for Fiscal Studies programme, funded by the UK's FCDO, building tax and social-protection policy data resources and tools with finance ministries and revenue authorities in Ethiopia, Ghana, Kenya, Nigeria, Rwanda and Uganda; about US\$6.36m disbursed 2023-2026	ADVANCED
Wind-down of a blockchain backer of African startups	An operating blockchain with a fund and accelerator pipeline backing African early-stage companies	The Swiss operator said on 25 August 2026 that it will discontinue its blockchain on 31 October 2026 and wind down its governance organisation, ending a funding and accelerator pipeline that had backed African companies in Nigeria, South Africa and Rwanda; it cited chain revenue insufficient to support its token, proposes burning 100 million tokens to cut supply from 400 million to 300 million, and has arranged a migration path for projects onto another chain. African blockchain startups raised US\$90.1m in 2025, down 26.6% on the year	CLOSED
EU Multiannual Indicative Programme for Sub-Saharan Africa 2021-2027	EUR 490m for priority area 4, Digital and Science, Technology and Innovation, of which EUR 240m for digital transformation, within a regional envelope of EUR 12,000m	Unchanged; the mid-term review cut priority area 4 from EUR 1,240m to EUR 490m and its digital transformation component from EUR 940m to EUR 240m, or 2.0 per cent of an envelope enlarged from EUR 10,242m to EUR 12,000m, and no later amendment is held	NO CHANGE

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Africa Finance Corporation digital bond	Baseline not held	CHF 350m raised on a five-year digital bond listed, traded and settled on a regulated digital exchange — stated as the first by an African institution — priced at a 1.4925% coupon and arranged by two European banks; it is the issuer's fourth and largest Swiss franc issuance	BASELINE NOT HELD
Africa50 Infrastructure Acceleration Fund	BASELINE NOT HELD	Fourth close of about US\$330m, joined by British International Investment's US\$20m commitment alongside the African Development Bank, the International Finance Corporation and more than 20 African institutional investors; the fund, managed by Africa Infrastructure Investment Partners, directs capital to logistics, power, water and sanitation and social infrastructure as well as digital connectivity; the size and date of earlier closes are not established	<i>Baseline not held</i>
African share of a European development group's digital portfolio	Baseline not held	EUR 558m, 59% of the group's standing digital portfolio of about EUR 948m and its largest region by a wide margin, against EUR 293m newly committed group-wide across 47 projects in 2025 and 152 projects in execution in 57 countries and territories (2025, published 2026-08-28)	BASELINE NOT HELD
AI 10 Billion Initiative	Did not exist	Launched, with a ten-month partnership roadshow to follow	BASELINE NOT HELD
BIASHARA 2063 project (AU Commission institutional systems)	BASELINE NOT HELD	A World Bank-financed programme building the Commission's own institutions and systems, procuring wireless infrastructure for its headquarters; no envelope, timetable or results framework held	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Capital raised by startups from a technology company's African accelerators	Baseline not held	More than US\$1bn raised cumulatively since 2017, with a stated survival rate above 90% against a 70-80% failure rate for the wider ecosystem (2026-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD
Development-finance and infrastructure-fund partnership	Baseline not held	A British development finance institution and a continental infrastructure fund announced a strengthened partnership to scale infrastructure financing across Africa, connectivity among the named sectors; no commitment amount, fund vehicle, country allocation or timetable is published	BASELINE NOT HELD
Growth-capital investment in a pan-African messaging infrastructure provider	Baseline not held	US\$12m into a provider of application-to-person messaging — one-time passwords, transaction alerts and delivery updates — operating across 35 African countries through 15 operator partnerships	BASELINE NOT HELD
KOICA Youth Leadership Programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	US\$34m stated by Korea for a programme coupling public governance and policy development with artificial-intelligence-driven digital government, hosted by the Ghana Institute of Management and Public Administration for 200 participants from Ghana, Nigeria, Cote d'Ivoire, Senegal and Cameroon, in three phases - online training, in-country sessions, and a funded 14-day study visit to Korea for the best performers	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Limited-partner commitments to African private-capital funds	Baseline not held	64 commitments in the second quarter of 2026 against 53 a year earlier, with disclosed value of US\$272m against US\$847m in the same quarter of 2025 and US\$1.18bn in the first quarter of 2026; no disclosed commitment above US\$50m, and information technology appeared in 61% of commitments against 17% a year earlier	BASELINE NOT HELD
LINGUA Africa language-model grants	Baseline not held	26 projects covering more than 50 African languages, dialects and sign languages across 47 countries, each awardee eligible for up to US\$250,000 in cash and US\$400,000 in compute credits; health, agriculture and justice are the stated use cases	BASELINE NOT HELD

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-05	MOVEMENT
Stage mix of a development financier's African portfolio	Not held	79% of one development financier's African deals are at Series B or later, so it operates less like a venture fund than a later-stage investor	BASELINE NOT HELD

Continental finance moved in two directions at once. Memoranda were signed with a search company on AI and cloud, with the telecommunications union across seven workstreams, and with an Indian technology company over five years; a development financier's African portfolio was shown to sit overwhelmingly at Series B or later, which is a later-stage position than a venture label implies.

Underneath, the money is contracting. Official development assistance fell in 2025 with more expected, the union's own budget is still only about a quarter member-financed a decade after the decision that was meant to change it, and the European programme's mid-term review cut its digital transformation component by roughly three quarters. Against the continental AI strategy, governments are reported to have committed [about US\\$150m of public capital](#) towards an implementation the strategy itself prices in the hundreds of billions. A year of signatures against a falling base is what this section records.

Where the record is thin

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Ratifications and domestication of the AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade	The AfCFTA Secretariat's or the depositary's ratification list, against the threshold the Protocol sets for entry into force; probed 2026-08-05: no depositary list located, but published legal analyses state the threshold is 22 state parties and that it has not been met, and name Nigeria as the first to approve ratification; located, not fetched	2026-08-05
Member-state implementation status of the AU Data Policy Framework	A Commission report on domestication by member state; probed 2026-08-05: no status report located, but the Commission held a validation workshop at Addis Ababa on 1-4 December 2025 on three draft continental frameworks — data categorisation and sharing, cross-border data flows, and an open data strategy — which the base does not hold at all; located, not fetched	2026-08-05
Budget of the African Union's own digital programme	A budget line for the Information Society division or the Digital Transformation Strategy, as against the Union's headline budget; probed 2026-08-05: the 2026 budget totals and the programme-budget split are published in secondary analyses, with no digital line disaggregated in anything located	2026-08-05

What the base cannot state at continental level is mostly the effect of what it can. There is no ratification count for the digital trade protocol, no budget for the union's own digital programme, no continental measure of workload concentration on foreign cloud, and no delivery figure against any of the training pledges made this year — a fifth memorandum signed in August adds three million learners to the pledged total and no method of counting them.

The pattern is consistent enough to name: continental instruments are adopted and announced in public, and their implementation is reported nationally or not at all. A reader wanting to know whether any of this reached a person has to go to the country reports, and for several of these instruments those reports are silent too.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.